

EMO is more than what meets the eye

What makes EMO stand out? Let us take a look.

Thoughtful design process.

EMO's unique design is a story that goes three levels with specific intents. First, perception of customers was captured, which helped designers understand the needs of people with respect to lighting.

Interestingly, during the second phase, a fictional alien character was devised in order to understand how people would interact with light around them. This yielded some very imaginative out-of-the-box unspoken uses cases.

"At a sub-conscious level, people would replace the alien with themselves and give out scenarios that they would like to experience with lighting," adds Nav Krishna.

During the final phase, acquired data was analysed and patterns allowed the designers of EMO to define product features that people would identify as personal.

Specific feedbacks. "During the above-mentioned design process, people gave us hints about what they would define as personal. We came up with a unique pinch interaction that does not currently exist to operate the product.

"They also said that a multi-functional product is more valuable than a single-feature product. So we gave multiple functional modes (functional and ambient). Once we built the prototype, we collected further feedback about how people see themselves us-

Playing with visual spectrum

EMO is a smart portable lighting device that comprises a proprietary light-emitting diode (LED) array that can be controlled via a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) controller. You can set a morning alarm and wake up to warm morning white light or set the light to act as notifications of missed calls or messages, or control the light in the surroundings with respect to any mood/feel setting you wish to set.

How do feel settings work. Users are given a choice of emotions or feel settings like relaxation, party and even panic setting. Each of these can be further modified based on personal preferences. These settings influence emotions through colour intensity loudness and frequency of change. For example, it could deliver a gentle bluish hue glow mimicking ocean waves when you select relaxation setting.

The built-in BLE controller linked to the smartphone application allows you to set different lighting experiences. The controller also holds algorithms for colour mixing and intensity control, which could be modified with just a scroll on the smartphone application.



Demonstration of EMO

ing the light," adds Nav Krishna.

EMO was further improved based on the feedback received. It now houses a safety beacon function that allows for easy spotting of a broken-down car at night.

"People told us what they really wanted and how they would like to use EMO in their lives," says Nav Krishna.

EMO is unique but not alone

There is a competitive world out there for EMO. Rousing Designs found that there are many lighting devices that exist in the market. Interestingly, after a detailed study they

found that there is no smart portable lighting solution that has the smart use cases that EMO houses.

"This is our minimum viable product. We have planned a product line around experiential controlled lighting of which this is a start. The market of smartlighting is set to grow to US\$ 8 billion by 2020, as per a published report. There are two more variants planned that will serve a wider set of needs and a hub system that will change the face of home lighting as we know it," says Nav Krishna.

Aravind Bayari, a senior embedded systems engineer, has been contributing to EMO's design right from its initial prototype.

How EMO finds light to illuminate itself

Rousing Designs has created something called a two-fold sales strategy. The first one is directed to people through a website. The online market-place provides a thriving platform to propel innovative smartproducts.

The second is through adventure enthusiasts who would find best use cases of EMO. The theme is to get EMO to people who go for weekend trips in their cars exploring wilderness or adventure.

Business plans also include partnering up with car rental platforms where EMO could be offered as an add-on inside the car. At the end of the day, this is a product that will prove handy when your car breaks down. **EFY**

Some interesting features

Unique functionality. EMO combines a functional, ambient and an emergency beacon.

Unique interaction. Pinch action to operate is a unique feature of the product that enhances intimacy at a sub-conscious level.

Amazing battery. EMO is powered by an 8000mAh battery option. The unit also works as a power bank as an added functionality.

Independent of the smartphone/smartdevice. Unlike other variants in the market, EMO has manual override if more intricate control is desired.

Minimalistic design. EMO has been designed to have minimum footprint. Added advantage of this is that it could be hung, mounted on metallic surfaces or could be used as a moodlight or a table lamp.